Y-B-91d
January 8, 1965

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. Y-B-0091c (AGR-AMS)
February 5, 1964 and
Fed. Spec. Y-B-91b
August 10, 1961

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BANANAS, FRESH

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for forms, sizes, stage of ripeness and grades, and method of packing fresh bananas.

1.2 Classification. Fresh bananas shall be of the following form, size, stage of ripeness and grade, as specified (see 6.1):

Form. Bananas shall be in (a) full bunches or (b) cut full hands, as specified (see 3.2.1 and 6.1).

Size. (If other than required in the grade) shall be as specified (see 3.2.1 and 6.1).

Stage of ripeness. Bananas shall be of the stage or stages of ripeness (a) turning-ripe, (b) firm-ripe, or (c) full-ripe, as specified (see 3.2.1.1 and 6.1).

Grade. Bananas shall be No. 1 grade (see 3.2.1).

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specification:

PPP-F-685—Fresh Fruits and Vegetables, Packaging, Packing, and Marking of.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification. Unless otherwise indicated, the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

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Governmental:

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement.

(Copies may be obtained upon application by money order, coupon, or cash to the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402. Prices may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.)

Nongovernmental:

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists.

(The above document is published by the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists, P.O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington, D., C. 20044.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall comply in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations promulgated thereunder.

3.2 Description of grades.

3.2.1 *No.* 1. No. 1 consists of bananas of a yellow variety which have reached a stage of maturity which will insure satisfactory completion of the ripening process, and which are clean, bright, firm, well developed, and free from damage materially affecting appearance, shipping quality, or edible quality caused by scars or other discoloration, decay, disease, chilling, heat, sunburn, spray-burn, chemicals, mechanical or other means.

When bananas are in bunches, stalks are trimmed close to upper and lower "hands" (4 to 6 inches) and stalks are free from damage by any cause. Unless otherwise specified, each bunch weighs not less than 50 pounds and contains not less than 8 "hands", each of which has not less than 8 "fingers".

When bananas are in "hands", the "hands" show a smooth cut where detached from the stalk and are free from portions of stalk. Each "hand" has 8 or more "fingers".

Unless otherwise specified, the maximum diameter of each banana shall be not less than 1-1/8 inches and the length not less than 5-1/2 inches, measured along the line of the central axis from blossom end to end of pulp.

Tolerances: *For defects*: Not more than 10 percent, by count, of individual bananas (fingers) in any lot may fail to meet grade requirements, including therein not more than 1 percent with defects which seriously affect edible quality. *For undersize fingers*: Not more than 15 percent by count may be smaller than required by the grade, or otherwise specified; but not more than 10 percent may be undersize for either diameter or length. *For bunches or hands*: Not more than 5 percent of either bunches or hands may fail to meet the requirements of the grade for trimming or the specified size of bunch or hand. *Application of tolerances*: The contents of individual packages or individual bunches in the lot, based on sample inspection, are subject to the following limitations: Provided, that the averages for the entire lot are within tolerances specified: For a tolerance of 10 percent or more, not more than one and one-half times the tolerance specified; and for a tolerance of less than 10 percent, not more than double the tolerance specified; except that in the case of bunches or hands this variation applies to fingers only, not to the tolerance of 5 percent for bunches or hands as a whole.

3.2.1.1 *Stages of ripeness.*

Turning-ripe is a stage in which most of the peel is a pale-yellow banana color with the tip end green. The flesh is decidedly starchy, with poor, very slightly tart flavor.

Firm-ripe is a stage in which the peel is a bright-yellow banana color with no more than a trace of green at the tips and no

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trace of brown specks. The flesh is firm and somewhat starchy with undeveloped flavor.

Full-ripe is a stage in which the peel is a typical yellow, ripe-banana color with flecks of light-brown to dark-brown specks varying in size from barely discernible to 1/8 inch in diameter. The flesh is mellow with practically all starch converted to sugar and the flavor fully developed.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling. Samples of bananas offered under this specification may be selected by the Government inspector, examined, and tested at any time to determine if they are in accordance with the requirements of this specification.

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 *General.* Inspection shall be made by the procuring agency or a duly authorized representative, at the time and place designated by the procuring agency. It may be made at the packing house, both during and after packing, at any suitable point in transit and after delivery to the point of destination. If inspection is made during the time of packing, the passing as satisfactory of any detail of packing or materials shall not relieve the contractor of responsibility for faulty workmanship or materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance.

4.2.2 *Responsibility for inspection.* The supplier is responsible for meeting all the provisions of the specification prior to submission to the Government for acceptance. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier is required to furnish an official inspection certificate issued by the U.S. Department of Agriculture certifying that the grade of the product supplied is as required in the contract or order.

4.2.2.1 Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be complete and made available to the Government as specifed in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2.2.2 *Inspection of packaging, packing, and marking.* Inspection of packaging, packing, and marking shall be in accordance with the applicable criteria of PPP-F-685.

4.2.3 *Determination of grade.* Determination of grade of product shall be in accordance with 3.2.1.

4.2.4 *Final inspection.* Unless otherwise specified, final inspection shall be made after delivery to the point of destination (see 6.3 and 6.4).

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 *Chemical analyses.* Chemical analyses, if required by the purchaser (see 6.1), shall be made in accordance with the methods of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists or in accordance with methods that give equivalent results. In case of dispute as to test results, the test methods specified herein will govern.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

For civil agency procurement, the definitions and applications of the levels of packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102.

5.1 Packing. Unless otherwise specified, the bananas shall be packed and marked in accordance with PPP-F-685.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.

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(*b*) Form required; cut hands or bunches (see 1.2).

(*c*) Size of bananas required, if other than designated in the grade (see 1.2).

(*d*) Stage or stages of ripeness required (see 1.2 and 3.2.1.1).

(*e*) When chemical analyses are required (see 4.3.1).

6.2 If samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

6.3 Contractor's inspection. The contractor should be required to assure that the product conforms with the specification prior to submission to the Government for final inspection.

6.4 Destination inspection. When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

6.5 Transportation description. Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Bananas, fresh (not cold-pack nor frozen).
Carload minimum weight 20,000 pounds.

Motor:

Bananas, fresh.
Truckload minimum weight 20,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army—GL

Navy—SA

Air Force—67

Review interest:

Army—MD

Navy—MC, SA

Air Force—67

User interest:

Army—SM

Review user information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current DOD Standardization Documents.

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

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